

Prospectus:

Figures and Horizons in Christian Ethics: An Introduction and Notebook Guide
by Asante Todd

Please find attached my Curriculum Vitae, prospectus, introduction and six (6) chapters for my 530 page, 132,000-word study in Christian Ethics, titled “*Figures and Horizons in Christian Ethics: An Introduction Notebook Guide*.”

This notebook is created as an introduction for those interested in the discipline of Christian ethics and is especially designed for students of religion, academics and scholars. It was born out of my own need to understand the discourse on Christian ethics not only as professor of Christian Ethics but also as an ordinary person wondering about how religious voices are responding to various moral and social issues of our times. This study finds that four main ethical norms have emerged in the discourse on Christian ethics over the course of the twentieth century: responsibility, equality and reconciliation, liberation, and ecological respect. These norms constitute a background of moral voices in contemporary Christian ethics. Other great books on ethics have also been written, and many of them have been helpful in my thinking. These include *An Introduction to Christian Ethics: History, Movements, People* by Harry J. Huebner (2012), Roger H. Crook’s *Introduction to Christian Ethics* (2012), and Robin Lovin’s *An Introduction to Christian Ethics: Goals, Duties, Virtues* (2011). Although each was helpful, I still had questions about how historical context shaped ethics, about how various ethical perspectives were in consonance and discord with one another, and about how each perspective offered its own world-horizon or perspective. I was also frustrated that I was often not privy to the primary texts of key figures, themselves, but that I often only encountered interpretations and/or paraphrases of these figures. This notebook tries to answer many of those questions. I thus treat the figures historically, framing the perspectives within larger social contexts. I treat them analytically, asking about the constituent parts of their perspective. I treat them hermeneutically, asking questions about how each perspective interprets the world, God, and the good life. Finally, the book intentionally re-presents much of their own language to and for the reader.

Chapter Outline:

Introduction

Why Another (Note)Book on Christian Ethics?

What Is Christian Ethics?

Public Theology

On Method

Major Themes and Debates

On the Discourse on Christian Ethics in the Twentieth Century

On The Theological Meanings of Progress

Christian Ethics Toward Beloved Community and the World House

Section 1 – The Ethics of the Social Gospel and Global Civil Society

- a. Introduction: Industrial Capitalism and the Gilded Age
- b. Walter Raushenbusch, the Social Gospel, and the Social Principles of Jesus
- c. Gary Dorrien and the Social Gospel Ethics of Equality and Cooperation

Section 2 – Of Responsibility and Freedom in Germany and the U.S.

- a. Introduction: Nazi Germany and the Third Reich
- b. Dietrich Bonhoeffer and the Ethics of Responsible Action
- c. H. Richard Niebuhr and the Ethics of the Responsible Self
- d. Paul Tillich and Christian Existentialism
- e. Karl Barth and the Divine Command of Freedom for the World

Section 3 – The Ethics of Equality and Reconciliation in the U.S

- a. Introduction: India and the Movement for Decolonization
- b. Reinhold Niebuhr and the Ethics of Equality and Nonviolent Resistance
- c. Howard Thurman and Mystic Ethics of Freedom and Reconciliation
- d. Martin Luther King Jr., and the Ethics of Love, Equality, and Nonconformity

Section 4 – The Ethics of Survival and Liberation in Latin America and the U.S.

- a. Introduction: Latin America and Global Industrialization
- b. Gustavo Gutierrez and the Ethics of Developmental Liberation
- c. Ada-Maria Isasi-Diaz and the Ethics of Mujerista Conscientization
- d. Elizabeth Johnson and Christian Feminist Ethics of Inclusive Care
- e. James Cone and Black Liberationist Ethics of Risk and Dialogue
- f. Katie Canon and the Black Womanist Ethics of Unctuousness
- g. Delores S. Williams and Black Womanist Ethics of Survival and Quality of Life

Section 5 – Excursus on Virtue in the Western World

- a. Introduction: Christian Virtue after Modern Autonomy
- b. Stanley Hauerwas and Postliberal Ethics of Servanthood and Christian Virtue
- c. Samuel Wells and Exemplary Ethics of Virtue and Improvisation
- d. John Finnis and New Natural Law Ethics as the Basic Forms of Good

Section 6 – The Ethics of Ecological Respect in Global Perspective

- a. Introduction: The Global Response to Ecological Crisis
- b. Melanie Harris and Ecowomanist Ethics of Love and Recognition
- c. Ivonne Gebara and Ecofeminist Ethics of Rights and Respect
- d. John B. Cobb, Jr., and Process Ethics of Respect and Responsibility
- e. Sharon Welch and Feminist Ethics of Risk and Respect
- f. Jay Emerson Johnson and the Queer Ethics of Dance and Disorderly Conduct

Section 7 – The Ethics of Healing and Reconciliation in South Africa and Malawi

- a. Introduction: Apartheid and Racism in the Modern World
- b. Alan Boesak and the Ethics of Reconciliatory Restitution
- c. Isabel Apawo Phiri and the Ethics of Healing and Peacemaking